

British Sign Language (BSL)					
	Nursery (Communication)	Reception (Communication)	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Receptive BSL	I can recognise and respond to basic greetings and familiar everyday signs. I can understand familiar signs for topics including emotions, colours, numbers and food. I can recognise simple affirmative and negative signs. I can understand simple WH questions when supported by familiar signs and context. I can follow familiar signed songs, rhymes and simple stories. I can begin to recognise meaning communicated	I can understand an increasing range of familiar signs relating to everyday topics, including family, animals, transport, feelings and food. I can understand numbers to 20 when used in familiar contexts. I can understand simple WH questions and respond appropriately. I can recognise how facial expression, eyebrow movement and body language contribute to meaning in BSL. I can follow simple signed narratives and identify key	I can understand an increasing range of signs relating to familiar and wider contexts, including celebrations, animals, places and travel. I can understand numbers to 31 when used in contexts such as dates and calendars. I can understand and respond to a wider range of BSL questions, including questions about what, where and how. I can follow a familiar signed story and respond to questions about it. I can recognise how facial expression, body movement and hand	I can understand a broader range of signed vocabulary relating to everyday life, travel, countries, school and occupations. I can understand signed questions and answers relating to familiar topics and experiences. I can follow increasingly detailed signed narratives and identify information about characters, actions, emotions and events. I can recognise how placement, direction and handshake contribute to meaning in BSL. I can recognise changes in meaning created through facial	I can follow and respond appropriately to signed instructions. I can understand increasingly detailed questions and responses in BSL. I can follow signed narratives and identify key information, characters and events. I can recognise how prepositions, placement and handshapes communicate spatial information. I can understand how timelines communicate when events take place, including today, yesterday, tomorrow, recently and a long time ago. I can recognise how intensifiers and facial expressions modify meaning. I can identify features of characterisation in signed stories.

	through facial expression, head movement and pointing.	characters, actions and feelings. I can understand simple signed exchanges using familiar BSL word order. I can follow another signer during a simple turn-taking conversation.	movement contribute to meaning. I can recognise that the same English word may be represented by different signs according to its meaning and context. I can recognise that BSL has its own linguistic structures and is not a signed form of English.	expression and other non-manual features. I can understand how signs can be modified to communicate intensity, for example the difference between performing an action gently and with greater effort. I can recognise the meaning of familiar directional verbs, including signs relating to helping, visiting, supporting, giving and asking.	I can recognise familiar multichannel signs and understand how features including appropriate lip patterns contribute to meaning.
Expressive BSL	I can use basic greetings and familiar everyday signs. I can use familiar signs to communicate simple needs, choices and feelings. I can use signs for familiar vocabulary, including colours, numbers and food. I can use simple affirmative and negative signs to communicate yes and no. I can use facial expressions and head	I can use an increasing range of signs to communicate about familiar topics, including family, animals, transport, feelings and food. I can use signs to describe simple features such as colour, size and number. I can express likes and dislikes using appropriate signs and non-manual features. I can ask and answer simple questions using familiar BSL structures. I can use facial expression, eyebrow movement and body	I can communicate about an increasing range of familiar topics and experiences using BSL. I can ask and answer questions about familiar topics using appropriate BSL structures. I can describe people, animals, objects and places using features such as colour, shape, size and other characteristics. I can use facial expression, body movement and hand movement to add meaning to my communication.	I can communicate with increasing confidence about familiar experiences, including travel, school and people in the community. I can ask and answer WH questions using appropriate BSL structures. I can describe people, objects, actions and experiences with increasing detail. I can use placement and direction to communicate where people and objects are located or moving. I can use facial expression and other non-manual features to	I can communicate increasingly detailed information and ideas using BSL. I can give clear signed instructions and respond appropriately within a signed exchange. I can ask and answer a range of questions using appropriate BSL structures and non-manual features. I can use placement, handshapes and spatial features to communicate meaning clearly. I can use signs and spatial relationships to communicate position, including concepts such as on, under and behind.

	movements to support the meaning of my signs. I can join in with familiar signed songs, rhymes and stories.	language to communicate meaning. I can use placement and referents when communicating about familiar people, objects and events. I can take turns appropriately in a simple signed conversation. I can retell parts of a familiar story using signs, actions and appropriate expression.	I can express preferences and feelings and give simple information about them. I can use signs appropriately according to their meaning and context. I can use handshapes and movement to communicate information about objects, transport and actions. I can respond to a signed story using BSL.	communicate feelings and modify meaning. I can modify signs and movement to express intensity, for example showing that an action is performed gently or with greater effort. I can use familiar directional verbs, including signs relating to helping, visiting, supporting, giving and asking. I can use signs relating to time to communicate when familiar events happen. I can retell elements of a familiar narrative using appropriate signs, expression and characterisation.	I can use timelines to communicate when events take place, including today, yesterday, tomorrow, recently and a long time ago. I can modify my signing using movement, facial expression and intensification to communicate more precise meaning. I can use characterisation when retelling or creating a short signed story. I can use familiar multichannel signs, including appropriate facial expression and lip pattern, within simple signed communication.
Vocabulary, Numbers and Fingerspelling	I can use and recognise an increasing range of familiar signs, including greetings, feelings, colours and food. I can use and recognise number signs from 1–10. I can use signs linked to familiar songs, rhymes and stories. I can begin to recognise that fingerspelling can be	I can use and recognise a wider range of vocabulary relating to familiar topics, including family, pets, animals, transport, feelings, food and colours. I can use and recognise number signs from 1–20. I can use number signs to communicate simple quantities and answer questions such as how many?	I can use and recognise an increasingly broad range of vocabulary relating to topics including celebrations, animals, places and travel. I can use and recognise number signs from 1–31. I can use number signs appropriately when communicating dates and age.	I can use and recognise a broadening range of vocabulary relating to travel, holidays, countries, school, clothing, subjects, occupations and everyday life. I can confidently use number signs from 1–31 in familiar contexts. I can use number signs when communicating about dates, days, months and times.	I can use and recognise an increasingly extensive range of vocabulary relating to familiar and curriculum-related topics, including weather, time, position, technology and Deaf culture. I can use and recognise number signs from 1–80. I can use number vocabulary accurately within familiar contexts. I can use an increasing range of signs relating to position and spatial

	used to represent letters and words. I can begin to copy simple fingerspelled letters with support.	I can recognise and produce an increasing number of fingerspelled letters. I can take part in simple fingerspelling games and activities. I can use familiar vocabulary with increasing accuracy within simple signed exchanges.	I can recognise and produce fingerspelled letters with increasing accuracy. I can use fingerspelling to support my communication when appropriate. I can understand that signs are selected according to meaning and context rather than by translating individual English words.	I can use vocabulary relating to time and routines, including the beginning and end of activities and events. I can fingerspell familiar words with increasing accuracy and fluency. I can use fingerspelling as one strategy to support communication when I do not know or need to clarify a sign. I can retain and reuse vocabulary learned in previous years in new contexts.	relationships, including on, under and behind. I can use vocabulary relating to time, including today, yesterday, tomorrow, recently and a long time ago. I can fingerspell familiar and unfamiliar words with increasing fluency and accuracy. I can use fingerspelling appropriately to support and clarify signed communication. I can independently recall and apply vocabulary learned previously when communicating in new contexts.
BSL Language and Linguistic Features	I can begin to understand that BSL uses signs, facial expressions and body movements to communicate meaning. I can use appropriate facial expressions and head movements when communicating simple feelings and responses. I can use head movements to communicate simple affirmation and negation.	I can use facial expression, eyebrow movement and body language to support meaning in BSL. I can use head movements and appropriate non-manual features to communicate affirmation and negation. I can begin to use referents and placement when communicating about people and objects.	I can ask and answer an increasing range of questions using appropriate BSL structures. I can use facial expression and body movement deliberately to add or change meaning. I can use handshape and movement to represent the shape and movement of familiar objects. I can use descriptive features of BSL to communicate information	I can use placement and direction to communicate spatial relationships in BSL. I can use handshapes and movement to represent how people or objects move. I can ask and answer WH questions using increasingly appropriate BSL structures. I can use facial expression and other non-manual features to modify meaning. I can modify movement and non-manual features to	I can use placement and spatial relationships accurately to communicate where people and objects are located. I can use signs relating to position, including on, under and behind. I can use handshape, movement and placement together to communicate increasingly precise meaning. I can use timelines to communicate when events occur, including today, yesterday, tomorrow, recently and a long time ago.

	I can begin to recognise and respond to WH questions in BSL. I can begin to use pointing appropriately as part of signed communication. I can explore different handshapes, movements and placements through familiar signs, songs and stories.	I can ask and answer simple questions using familiar BSL structures. I can begin to organise familiar signs using appropriate BSL order rather than English word order. I can use signs and non-manual features to communicate likes and dislikes. I can begin to use simple timelines to communicate today, yesterday and tomorrow. I can use appropriate turn-taking conventions during a simple signed conversation.	about size, shape and other characteristics. I can recognise that the same English word may require different signs according to its meaning and context. I can select signs according to meaning rather than translating English word for word. I can recognise that BSL has its own structure and linguistic features and is different from English.	communicate intensity, such as distinguishing between an action completed gently and one completed with greater effort. I can use familiar directional verbs, including signs relating to helping, visiting, supporting, giving and asking. I can use signs relating to time and sequence to communicate when events happen. I can use characterisation and appropriate non-manual features when communicating elements of a signed narrative.	I can use facial expression and other non-manual features deliberately to modify and intensify meaning. I can use appropriate eyebrow movement and facial expression when asking questions. I can use characterisation when communicating through signed stories. I can recognise and use familiar multichannel signs, combining manual and non-manual features, including appropriate lip patterns. I can begin to explain how features such as handshape, placement, movement, facial expression and lip pattern contribute to meaning in BSL.
Deaf Awareness, Culture and Identity	I can begin to understand that some people are Deaf and communicate using BSL. I can recognise BSL as a way that people communicate with one another. I can begin to use appropriate ways of gaining and maintaining	I can understand that Deaf people may use BSL to communicate. I can demonstrate basic Deaf awareness when communicating with another person. I can use appropriate eye contact, facial expression and body language during signed communication.	I can understand that BSL is a language in its own right and is different from English. I can demonstrate appropriate behaviours when communicating with a Deaf person or BSL user. I can understand that signs communicate meaning and are not simply English	I can understand that sign languages are not the same across different countries. I can recognise BSL as the sign language used by many Deaf people in the UK. I can demonstrate appropriate Deaf awareness when communicating with others. I can begin to identify some communication barriers that a	I can explain that BSL is a language used by members of the Deaf community and describe some of its functions. I can explain some appropriate conventions within Deaf culture, including the use of pointing and waving to communicate and gain attention. I can understand that Deaf people have different experiences and that terms including Deaf, hard of hearing,

	another person's attention when signing. I can begin to understand that pointing, facial expression and eye contact are important features of communication in BSL. I can join in positively with signed songs, stories and everyday communication.	I can understand that pointing and referents are appropriate and important features of BSL. I can take turns appropriately during a signed conversation. I can begin to recognise BSL as a language with its own structures and conventions.	words represented with the hands. I can recognise that people may communicate in different ways and use different languages. I can begin to understand that sign languages can be connected to different communities and cultures.	Deaf person might experience in everyday life. I can consider how communication can be made more accessible for a Deaf person. I can apply my Deaf awareness to familiar situations, such as considering how a Deaf person might communicate when seeking help or contacting an emergency service. I can show respect for different ways of communicating and for the experiences of Deaf people.	hearing and deafened describe different experiences or identities. I can identify examples of technology and equipment that may support Deaf and hard-of-hearing people in everyday life. I can recognise technologies including hearing aids and cochlear implants and understand that Deaf people may use different forms of communication and technology. I can explain the role of a BSL interpreter. I can identify some communication barriers experienced by Deaf people and consider ways communication can be made more accessible. I can understand that lipreading has uses and limitations and cannot provide complete access to spoken language. I can demonstrate increasingly informed and respectful Deaf awareness in my communication and interactions.
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